

DailyDigest_AI TechNews - 2026-09-29

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Source: <https://techcrunch.com/category/artificial-intelligence/>

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11. Insurtech Outmarket raises \$34.5M just months after prior round

Insurance-tech startup Outmarket raised \$34.5M shortly after its last round, signaling strong investor demand.

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12. Viral AI agent Instinct raises \$1B Series C at a \$10B valuation

AI agent startup Instinct raised \$1B at a \$10B valuation, underscoring how hot the agent market is.

<https://techcrunch.com/2026/09/28/viral-ai-agent-instinct-raises-1b-series-c-at-a-10b-valuation/>

Top themes today: AI agents (commerce & control), new model/product launches (Sonnet 5.5, Gemini skills), enterprise AI push, AI startup funding

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12. Your final chance to grab your exhibit table at TechCrunch Disrupt 2026 is October 2

TechCrunch extended the Disrupt 2026 exhibitor sign-up deadline to October 2.

<https://techcrunch.com/2026/09/28/disrupt-2026-exhibitor-program-extended-until-oct-2/>

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15. Anthropic's CEO is about to have dinner with President Trump

Anthropic's CEO is set to meet President Trump, a notable moment for AI-industry ties with the White House.

<https://techcrunch.com/2026/09/27/anthropics-ceo-is-about-to-have-dinner-with-president-trump/>

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1. Peak XV ups Surge seed investment ceiling to \$5M, unveils 18-startup cohort

Peak XV's Surge program will now invest up to \$5M at seed and announced 18 new startups in its latest cohort.

<https://techcrunch.com/2026/09/28/peak-xv-goes-bigger-at-seed-with-new-surge-cohort-as-series-a-bar-rises/>

2. OpenAI reportedly ditches model over safety concerns

OpenAI has reportedly dropped a model because of safety concerns, a sign safety reviews can halt releases.

<https://techcrunch.com/2026/09/28/openai-reportedly-ditches-model-over-safety-concerns/>

3. Source: Inference provider Modal Labs closing in on \$750M round at \$15.75B valuation

AI inference provider Modal Labs is reportedly near a \$750M raise at a \$15.75B valuation, showing strong demand for AI compute infrastructure.

<https://techcrunch.com/2026/09/28/source-inference-provider-modal-labs-closing-in-on-750m-round-at-15-75b-valuation/>

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6. The AI boom took over Climate Week and not everyone is happy about it

AI dominated the conversation at Climate Week, drawing pushback from some attendees.

<https://techcrunch.com/2026/09/28/the-ai-boom-took-over-climate-week-and-not-everyone-is-happy-about-it/>

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